

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Some devastating news for Meenee!



Learning Outcome

Relate information about common solutions to problems in spoken and written documents.

Ask your partner:

- Do you own a pet? What kind?
- How often do you take it to the veterinary surgery?
- What happened that last time you were there?

Can Do Statements

- I can write about reactions and behavior.
- I can quote other people in a written way.
- I can write about hypothetical situations about the past.

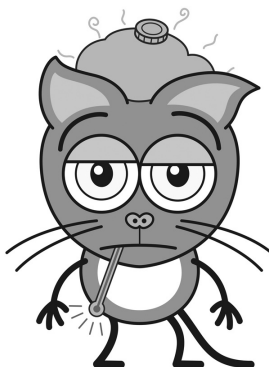




Let's Explore!

Sally is given a tragic **prognosis*** on her dear cat.

* A "prognosis" is a medical term that means the likely outcome of a person or animal.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Sally:** Hey, where are you?
Vanessa: I'm just leaving Starbucks, grabbed a cappuccino.
Sally: If I had known that, I would have asked you to pick me up one, and a brownie too.
Vanessa: Need a chocolate fix?
Sally: Yeah ... I just got some upsetting news from the vet. I'm a bit of a mess.
Vanessa: What? Is Meenee sick? You didn't tell me that.
Sally: Well, I took him in for his yearly checkup. They told me they needed to draw some blood after a physical examination.
Vanessa: And?
Sally: They said that there are some grave concerns about his heart. They don't expect him to live through the winter.
Vanessa: I'm so sorry to hear that. Did the vet suggest anything to improve his quality of life?
Sally: The nurse said that there was very little I could do apart from keeping him comfortable.
Vanessa: That would have been devastating to hear.
Sally: I just feel so guilty. I should have recognized that there was a problem.
Vanessa: Don't be ridiculous! You are a devoted pet owner. Meenee's your fur baby!
Sally: I know but there were signs, now that I think of it. If I had spent more time with him, I might have seen that he was sleeping more than usual.
Vanessa: Don't beat yourself up about it. You couldn't have been any more committed to him. He is now on medication, right?
Sally: I just feel so lost. He's like a family member, you know?
Vanessa: I understand. I'm turning around in the parking lot. Your cappuccino and brownie are on their way!



Let's Practice!

The veterinary clinic makes a difficult call to Sally about her fur baby, Meenee.

Instructions: Match the initial halves on the left to their corresponding ending halves on the right.

- | | |
|--|--|
| 1) They told me that they needed to draw | a) that there was very little I could do apart from keeping him comfortable. |
| 2) They said that there are some grave | b) concerns about his heart. |
| 3) They don't expect | c) to improve his quality of life? |
| 4) Did the vet suggest anything | d) some blood after a physical examination. |
| 5) The nurse said | e) him to live through the winter. |



Let's Practice!

Dealing with a sick or injured pet can be difficult. Imagine you have just received a phone call from the veterinarian* to say that your pet is seriously ill. What is their diagnosis?*

*A "veterinarian" is a person who practices medicine on animals.

**A "diagnosis" is the identification of a disease through examination.

Instructions: Write a 150-170 word diary entry about the phone call and your reaction to the news.

Include the date and greeting Dear Diary,

Describe your pet. Is it a dog? Bird? Horse?

Write about why you took your pet to a veterinary surgery. What symptoms did it have?

What does the staff say? What is their diagnosis? Quote the veterinarian in a written way

Example:

She said that they could give him some medication for the pain.

What was your reaction to the news? Were you devastated?

Write three sentences about hypothetical situations in the past.

Examples:

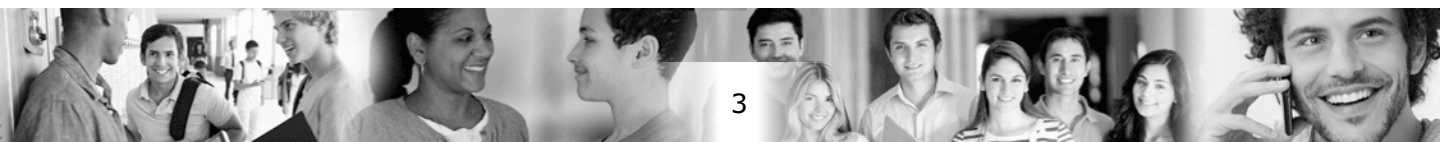
If I had spent more time with him, I might have seen that he was sleeping more than usual.

If I had known that, I would have asked you to pick me up one, and a brownie too.

Did you call anyone?

Example: I immediately called my best friend.

What are the next steps? What do you plan to do in the future?





Extension Activity

Report a friend's offer of help.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Work in a group of three.
- Student 1 will briefly talk about a problem he or she has.
- Student 2 will talk about what he or she will do to help.
- Student 3 will tell student 1 what student 2 said, using reported speech.
- Change roles.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write about reactions and behavior.

☐
☐

I use reported speech in my writing.

☐
☐

I write about hypothetical situations about the past.

☐
☐

I talk about a problem, give advice and report on someone else's advice.

☐
☐


Target Words

- fix** (noun): dose or amount to satisfy a craving
e.g. Need a chocolate fix?
- to draw** (verb): to take or pull out
e.g. They told me they needed to draw some blood.
- grave** (adjective): very serious; requiring or causing serious thought or concern
e.g. I have some grave concerns about my dog's health.
- quality of life** (noun): the standard of health, comfort, and happiness in one's life
e.g. Did the vet suggest anything to improve his quality of life?
- devoted** (adjective): having strong love or loyalty for something or someone
e.g. You are a devoted pet owner.
- beat oneself up** (expression): to be overly critical of oneself
e.g. Don't beat yourself up about it.
- fur baby** (expression): name given to pets that are treated like children
e.g. Meenee is my fur baby.





Learning Points

Talking Hypothetically About the Past

You can use sentences with **if** to talk hypothetically about the past.

You use the Past Perfect form of the *if*-clause and a past modal in the main clause.

If + Past Perfect + Past modal

would have, could have, might have

Note: People often say *If I would have* instead of *If I had*, but this is not correct in writing.

Examples:

- *You should have told her about that important matter.*
- *If I had spent more time with him, I might have seen that he was sleeping more than usual.*
- *If I had known that, I would have asked you to pick me up one, and a brownie too.*





Learning Points

Reported Speech and Questions

You use a reporting verb like *to say* or *to tell* about what someone said in a conversation.

For example: *She said (that) my cat needed some additional tests.*

Reported questions are one form of reported speech.

You usually introduce reported questions with the verb *to ask*.

Here are some examples:

The vet **asked** (me) **if/whether...** (YES/NO questions)

The nurse **asked** (me) **why/when/where/what/how...** (question-word questions)

You may need to change pronouns and tense as well as time and place in reported questions.

The word order is like that of a normal statement (subject-verb-object).

Tense	Direct Speech	Reported Speech
Present Simple tense	<i>I love my cat, Meeneee.</i>	<i>She said (that) she loved her cat, Meeneee.</i>
Present Continuous tense	<i>I am living in the same apartment.</i>	<i>She said (that) she was living in the same apartment.</i>
Past Simple tense	<i>I bought a new collar for my cat.</i>	<i>Sally said (that) she had bought a new collar for her cat.</i>
Past Continuous tense	<i>I was playing in the backyard with my cat.</i>	<i>She said (that) she had been playing in her backyard with her cat.</i>
Present Perfect tense	<i>I haven't seen that other cat across the hallway.</i>	<i>She said (that) she hadn't seen that other cat across the hallway.</i>

Examples:

- *The nurse asked me what I was feeding him.*
- *The vet asked me if they could keep Meeneee overnight.*
- *The veterinarian told me that my beloved cat was very sick.*

